

uses the same IP address to access the Web—that is, the IP address of the proxy server.

- Universities, libraries, and cyber-cafes allow lots of people to access the Web using the same computer, the same IP address, which can be interpreted as the same user making repeated visits to the site.
- “Spider” or “robot” software are Internet robots (used by search engines) that explore the Web and collect Web page addresses based on content found at those pages. Often, a page view is just a spider crawling through, but is reported as an individual client with a separate IP address.

2. Same Web site, different servers

Sometimes Web sites are so large that they need to spread out their pages on multiple servers to enable easy access to the large number of requests they receive at the same time. Duration of a page view is therefore only really assessable on individual servers. In such cases, the quantum of time spent on a Web site would not be visible on every individual server that holds a part of the content of the Web site.

3. Size Matters

Some Web server programs always record the exact, actual size of the file that is being sent. In such a case, if a particular user stops downloading large graphics files mid-way through the process, the server still reports the file size, instead of the actual amount of data served.

4. The Referrer Field

Often, a log file shows the URL of the page that contains the hyperlink you used to access the current page. This enables the maintainers of the Web site to tell which Web site referred the user there. The referrer field reveals which page the visitor was on when he clicked to come to this page. Usually this will mean that the page had a link to that particular site. But sometimes this is simply the page the user was looking at when they typed in your address into their browser, or clicked on your address in some other software such as a newsreader or an e-mail client. Using the